AFTERCARE

Caring for Your Gel Nails

Your gel is fully cured before you leave. A few easy habits keep it glossy, strong and chip-free, and keep your natural nails healthy underneath.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First 24 hours fully cured	Nails feel smooth, strong and a little thicker. Any tightness from prep fades quickly.	Apply cuticle oil tonight. Wear gloves for cleaning and washing dishes.	Long hot soaks, hot tubs and saunas. Harsh cleaners or self-tanner on bare hands.
Week 1 enjoy them	Glossy, chip-free nails. A tiny gap may show at the cuticle by the end of the week.	Cuticle oil daily and hand cream after washing. Dry your nails well after water.	Opening cans, scraping labels or picking at edges. Your nails are jewels, not tools.
Weeks 2–3 growing out	Regrowth shows at the cuticle. Free edges can wear a little at the tips.	Smooth any snag with a fine file. Book your next visit before you leave.	Picking, peeling or biting gel. It pulls off layers of your natural nail with it.
Fill time next visit	Gel polish is ready to soak off at [2–3] weeks; builder gel needs an infill at [3–4] weeks.	Come in for a professional soak-off or infill. Tell me about new medications or allergies.	Leaving gel on for many weeks, or removing it at home by peeling, prying or clipping.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Acetone-based removers can dull the shine
- Water trapped under lifting can lead to infection
- Short to medium lengths wear the longest
- Sunscreen and bug spray can soften top coat; wipe off
- A lifted edge? Book a fix; don't glue or clip it
- Oil keeps gel flexible, so it chips and lifts less
- Your nails rest best with oil and time between sets
- Keep a fine file handy; never use clippers on gel

Oil daily
Cuticle oil keeps nails and gel flexible.

Gloves on
Cleaning, dishes and gardening.

Hands off
No picking, peeling or biting.

Pro removal
Soak-off only, never pry or peel.

CALL ME RIGHT AWAY IF YOU NOTICE

- Itching, redness or a rash around your nails
- Lifting, or a gap opening under the gel
- Swelling or blisters on fingertips, face or eyelids
- A green or dark spot under the gel

Pain, heat, throbbing or pus around a nail: see your doctor. Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

YOUR GEL & SHADE _____

CUTICLE OIL TO USE _____

YOUR NEXT VISIT DATE _____